

Vinay Degavath

Head of Product | DeFi · CeFi · Protocol Design

IIT Kharagpur | Token 2049 Speaker

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SUMMARY

Product leader, 13+ years DeFi/fintech. Founded Hashstack (under-collateralized lending on Starknet; 61% utilization, 36K on-chain users). Raised \$1M seed + additional private funding, launched HSTK on Uniswap/Ekubo, authored EIP-5299. Head of Product at Finin (employee #2, neobank acquired by Open Financial Technologies).

EXPERIENCE

Hashstack Finance

2020 – 2026

Founder & CEO — [hashstack.finance](#)

Bengaluru

- Raised \$1M seed + additional private funding; acquired 36,000 on-chain users at \$55 per user. Generated \$56K+ revenue in first year of operations
- Designed [Degen Mode](#) — one-click leveraged strategy execution that abstracted borrow/swap/LP into automated strategies while constraining borrowed capital to on-protocol deployment for solvency
- Designed the [Dynamic Interest Algorithm \(DIAL, v1\)](#) for term-deposit lending (utilization + commitment tranches). Evolved to a [Interest Rate Model \(v2\)](#) — kinked utilization curve — in production for auditability and determinism
- Led product across engineering, community, and BD with a 16-person team. Deprioritized CEX listing to focus on protocol security — culminating in a [CertiK security audit](#)
- Launched HSTK on Uniswap (Ethereum) and Ekubo (Starknet); managed tokenomics, vesting, and liquidity. Secured 180,000 STRK and \$50K (Harmony) in ecosystem grants across 4 rounds
- Orchestrated 7 protocol integrations (Aave, Chainlink, Herodotus, ZKLend, Myswap, Jediswap, Chainstack). Authored [EIP-5299](#) — proposed Layer3 scaling EIP
- Led structured wind-down — Starknet adoption stalled and Cairo 2.0 migration cost exceeded expected ROI. Deployed testnet on Base to validate cross-chain portability

Finin

Oct 2019 – Jul 2020

Head of Product — [acquired by Open Financial Technologies](#)

Bengaluru

- Employee #2. Built engineering team from 0 to 16
- Shipped core neobanking product end-to-end — savings accounts, cards, onboarding
- Integrated State Bank of Mauritius as core banking partner
- Acquired 5,000 savings accounts through product-led growth
- Company acquired by Open Financial Technologies — validated product-market fit

Guardrail

2016 – Present

Managing Partner — [guardrail.fund](#)

- Conviction-driven single-family office deploying principal capital across digital assets, precious metals, real estate, and frontier tech. 10+ year horizon
- Sourced and evaluated deal flow; developed market theses for early-stage digital assets (2017–2019). Angel investor in Gushwork (\$9M seed)

Earlier Experience

Echo · Qulp · AIESEC

- **Echo** (Co-founder, 2016–2017) — Location-based social discovery. Facebook FBSTART. SURGE 2016. 3,000 users. #13 India Play Store, zero marketing spend
- **Qulp** (Founder, 2013–2015) — Hardware innovation platform. Google Launchpad 2014. TiE Asia regional finalists 2014. \$60K in pre-orders. Team of 7
- **AIESEC IIT Kharagpur** (VP Marketing & PR, 2010–2013) — Led 13-person team across promotions, branding, and media. 1st place, Nokia–AIESEC India campaign

PUBLISHED WORK & SPEAKING

EIP-5299: Layer3 Scaling Standard — discussion

Open Protocol Whitepaper

DIAL: Dynamic Interest Algorithm (v1) — Interest Rate Model (v2)

Speaker, Token 2049 (2022)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Solidity, Cairo, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL

Protocols: Starknet, Ethereum, L2/ZK Architecture

Tools: Dune Analytics, Jira/Linear, Notion, Amplitude, Figma, GitHub

CORE COMPETENCIES

Protocol Design · Token Economics · DeFi Mechanics · Product Strategy · 0→1 Product Building · Team Leadership · Cross-chain Architecture · L2/ZK · Risk Framework Design · Go-to-Market

EDUCATION

Indian Institute of Technology, Kharagpur